

# Nick Nikolaev

## Tech Lead | Full Stack | Product Strategy

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### SUMMARY

- On-site in **Zurich, immediately available**, and fully eligible to work thanks to an **EU passport**.
- Led a **5-person product team**, defining and executing quarterly OKRs and running team meetings. (**Cambridge IELTS certified**)
- **Founding Engineer** (first hire), working directly with the CEO and CTO behind **\$2B+** in shareholder value creation.
- Engineered microservices for automated file ingestion with polyglot data persistence, adopted by **Allianz** and **Fidelity Investments**

### EXPERIENCE

10/2022 - 01/2026

Remote | CA, USA

Alignment.io

Tech Lead

<https://www.alignment.io>

US-based AI SaaS for enterprise strategy alignment & OKRs used by tech teams.

- **Situation:** The platform lacked structured QA and release processes and enterprise-grade capabilities, while users also lacked real-time collaboration features during quarterly planning. Engineering execution lacked clear ownership despite a company-wide quarterly plan, limiting stability, adoption, and B2B sales.
- **Task:** Improve system stability, enable enterprise adoption, and build real-time collaboration while taking ownership of engineering execution.
- **Action:** Led a 5-person engineering team (2 QA engineers, 3 developers), taking ownership of delivery, QA, and release processes. Introduced structured QA workflows and release processes, and implemented quarterly OKRs with weekly planning to improve execution and alignment. Built and shipped enterprise features including role-based access control (RBAC), authentication, and global search, as well as a real-time AI-powered chat system with mentions and file sharing, and a dashboard for quarterly alignment tracking.
- **Result:** Reduced production incidents by ~90%, enabled 3+ enterprise deals (incl. DefenseStorm), doubled onboarding efficiency, improved collaboration across 90K+ projects, and strengthened overall product execution.
- **Tech Stack**  
Frontend: HTML, CSS, Tailwind  
Backend: JavaScript (Node.js, Express.js), WebSockets, REST APIs  
Data & Infra: Redis, MySQL, AWS, Docker, CI/CD  
Authentication & Security: OAuth 2.0, SAML SSO  
AI Integration: OpenAI API, Anthropic Claude API  
Tools & Methods: Cursor (AI-assisted development), Git/GitHub, Agile/Scrum  
Mobile: Flutter (WebView)  
Additional: Legacy frontend (jQuery)

07/2021 - 10/2022

Remote | AL, USA

TheDataGroup

Back End Developer

<https://www.thedatagroup.cloud>

US-based B2B data platform startup that helps companies unify and manage data across multiple systems.

- **Situation:** Wealth management firms stored financial data across fragmented file formats (PDF, DOCX, CSV), making automated financial reporting and analysis difficult.
- **Task:** Build a secure data ingestion pipeline to extract, normalize, and load these files into a centralized data warehouse for downstream analytics.
- **Action:** Designed and implemented a microservices-based ingestion system integrating secure SFTP transfers and authenticated APIs. Worked closely with data engineers to define transformation logic and developed SQL-based processing workflows in Snowflake.
- **Result:** Enabled daily ingestion of structured data, powering automated financial reporting and improving data availability for analytics teams.
- **Tech Stack**  
Backend: JavaScript (Node.js, Express.js), Microservices, REST APIs  
Data & Infra: MSSQL, MySQL, Postgre, Snowflake, AWS  
Authentication & Security: SFTP (SSH key-based authentication)  
Tools & Methods: WebStorm, Git/GitHub, Agile/Scrum

# EXPERIENCE

06/2020 - 06/2021

Dülmen, Germany

Hazemag.com

## Full Stack Developer

<https://www.hazemag.com>

Established industrial equipment company (founded 1946) for mining & cement, serving global operators.

- **Situation:** Operators at a coal-washing plant in Indonesia lacked real-time visibility into machine status, spare parts availability, and overall system health across 20+ industrial machines.
- **Task:** Design and implement a real-time monitoring system providing operational visibility across machines and supporting maintenance decision-making.
- **Action:** Analyzed engineering documentation and collaborated with project owners and sensor data engineers to define system requirements. Built a backend service and data storage architecture to process and serve real-time machine and inventory data. Integrated sensor streams using mySCADA, implemented authentication, and developed a visualization interface combining 2D dashboards with 3D elements.
- **Result:** Enabled real-time monitoring of 20+ machines, significantly improving operational awareness and allowing 10 operators to detect and respond to failures faster.
- **Tech Stack**  
Operating System: Linux  
Frontend: mySCADA  
Backend: JavaScript (Node.js, Express.js), REST APIs  
Data & Infra: MongoDB



# SKILLS

- **Languages:** JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SQL
- **Technologies:** React, Node.js, MySQL, Postgres, MSSQL, Snowflake, AWS, Git, Docker

# EDUCATION

2020 - 2022

Bulgaria

NVNA

## B.Sc. in Cybersecurity

Grade 5.0 / 6.0

# LANGUAGES



# REFERENCES

## JIM BENTON

- Managing Partner - [Alignment.io](#)
- Former CEO - [Chorus.ai](#) (\$575M acquisition)
- Former CEO - [Apollo.io](#) (Unicorn, \$1.6B valuation)
- Email: [jl.benton@gmail.com](mailto:jl.benton@gmail.com)
- LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/benton](https://www.linkedin.com/in/benton)

## GIDON WISE

- CTO - [Alignment.io](#)
- Founding CTO - [DistroKid.com](#) (Unicorn, \$1.3B valuation)
- Email: [gidon@gidon.com](mailto:gidon@gidon.com)
- Phone: +1 (646) 552-4228
- Note: "Happy to discuss Nick."

# CERTIFICATES

## 18.01.2x: Calculus 1B – Integration

Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MITx) – edX Online Learning Initiative

## Success (Personal Development Course)

University of Pennsylvania – Coursera Online Course

## CERTIFICATES

### **Improving Communication Skills**

University of Pennsylvania – Coursera Online Course

## INTERESTS

### **Kickboxing & Gym**

Trained under a Balkan champion & sparred with professional fighters